

May

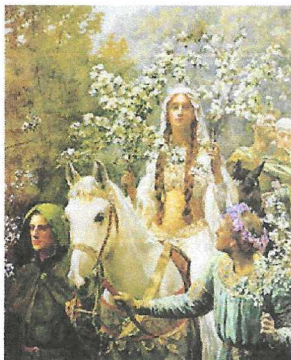
*May brings flocks of pretty lambs
Skipping by their fleecy dams*

Sarah Coleridge



Tony Richards

- *Named after Greek goddess Maia, identified with Roman goddess of fertility, Bona Dea,*
 - *May's flower of the month Hawthorn and Lily of the Valley*
 - *May's birthstone is Emerald, emblem of love and success*
 - *May's signs of the Zodiac are Taurus and Gemini*



Ancient spring festival and a traditional spring holiday in many cultures. Celebrated in Europe and north and south America with dancing, often round a maypole and morris men and women, singing and the crowning of the Queen of May.

In the late 19th century, May Day was chosen as the date for International Workers' Day

Queen Guinevere's Maying by John Collier

May

Among many festivities

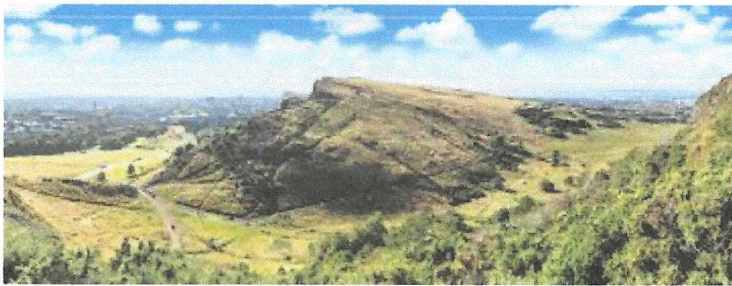
Oxford's May Morning revels beginning at 6 am. Hope you've all been, maybe in your youth?

Padstow in Cornwall with its 'Obby-'Oss (Hobby Horse) day of festivities – now one of the most famous folk customs in Britain.



Hastings has the Jack in the Green festival with lots of morris dancers.

Peebles in the Scottish Borders has a parade and a pageant and their annual Common Riding



An old Edinburgh tradition has it that young women who climb Arthur's Seat and wash their faces in the morning dew will have lifelong beauty.

In Wales traditions would start the night before with bonfires, and decorating houses with hawthorn and flowers to celebrate new growth and fertility. May Day celebrations would include summer dancing and May carols.



May

May Day is celebrated in Ireland, Scotland, Wales and the Isle of Man as the feast of



Beltane/fire.

Traditionally, bonfires were lit to mark the coming of summer and to grant luck to people and livestock.

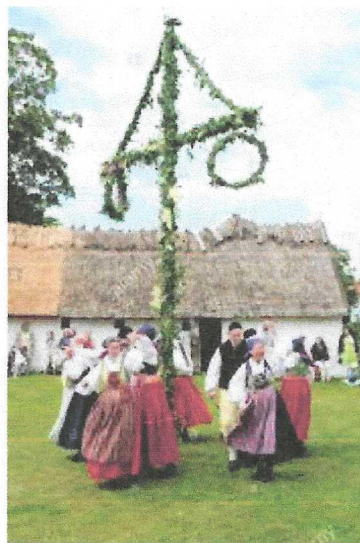
Dancing round the maypole here, across Europe and across the Atlantic



One last note. the last bank holiday in May represents Whit Monday



in Germany



in Sweden



in Jamaica